

VirtualWorks Pharmacovigilance Internship

Task 1 – ADR Identification Basics

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Case: Educational simulated pharmacovigilance case

1. Patient Case Scenario

A 50-year-old male patient was treated for a bacterial infection with **ciprofloxacin 500 mg orally twice daily**. On the same day treatment was started, he developed **generalized urticaria (hives)**. Ciprofloxacin was stopped and treatment for the allergic reaction was provided. The patient subsequently recovered. Paracetamol was also being used as a concomitant medicine.

2. Case Analysis

Parameter	Finding
Patient	50-year-old male
Suspected drug	Ciprofloxacin
Dose / route	500 mg orally, twice daily
Indication	Bacterial infection
Adverse reaction	Generalized urticaria (hives)
Onset	Same day after starting ciprofloxacin
Action taken	Ciprofloxacin withdrawn
Outcome	Recovered

3. ADR Identification

Identified ADR: Generalized urticaria (hives).

Suspected medicine: Ciprofloxacin.

Assessment: The reaction is suspected to be drug-related because it occurred soon after ciprofloxacin exposure and the medicine was withdrawn after the reaction.

4. Alternative Causes

The underlying infection and concomitant medicines should also be considered as possible alternative explanations. Based on the information available, ciprofloxacin remains the main suspected medicine, but the case does not establish absolute proof of causation.

5. Final Conclusion

ADR identified: Generalized urticaria (hives). **Suspected drug:** Ciprofloxacin 500 mg orally twice daily. **Case outcome:** Recovered after withdrawal and treatment.

Note: This is an educational simulated case prepared for internship practice. It should not be used as a real patient record.

References: WHO-UMC. The use of the WHO-UMC system for standardised case causality assessment; Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission, Pharmacovigilance Programme of India guidance.